



The job of a data analyst

Previously, we learned about

what a data analyst does and why that work is so valuable. Now, let's look at where data analysts actually do their work. You'll learn much more about the industries you could work in as a data analyst. And how companies in these fields are already using data analytics to do some really cool things. There are so many businesses out there that have a big need for the skills you're learning right now. Across industries like technology,

marketing, finance, health care, and so many more. Real companies are already using data analytics to stay ahead of the curve. And the more they use data in their business, the more they understand just how important data analyst

like you are to their success. Let's look at a real life example of

a brand you'll probably recognize, Coca-Cola. Data is changing the way Coca-Cola approaches its marketing strategies. Coca-Cola uses data gathered from

consumer feedback to create advertising that speaks directly to different

audiences with different interests. How does this work? You know those high tech Coca-Cola vending machines you see at movie theater sometimes? It's always fun getting

to make your own flavors. Well, those machines have built-in

artificial intelligence and data analysis tools. This helps Coca-Cola see all the different

kinds of flavor combinations people are coming up with, which they can then

use as inspiration for new products. How cool is that? Ever wonder how Google gives you the right

answer to any question in just seconds? That's powered by data too. We use all kinds of data to

determine a website's reliability and accuracy to make sure you get the most useful results for any search you make. But it isn't just big companies like Coca-Cola and Google that use data. Small businesses everywhere are also starting to take advantage of data driven insights to improve their operations and make better decisions. Small businesses can use data to do all kinds of things. They might use data analytics to better understand their customers' buying habits, create more effective social media messaging, or, in the case of one city zoo and aquarium, predict the number of daily visitors based on local climate data. City zoo and aquarium realized that, on rainy days, they were seeing huge drop offs in attendance, but they had no way to accurately predict when those rainy days would hit. This made staffing a real challenge. Some days they found themselves overstaffed, other days they were unprepared for the rush of visitors. To deal with this, data analyst took years of weather records from the zoo and use that data to accurately predict future weather patterns. This made it easy for the zoo to know how much staff they needed when. Because the zoo could predict and manage their staffing needs more accurately, they were able to provide a better experience for visitors and dedicate more resources to creating a better experience for the animals too. We see a similar thing in the healthcare industry. Their data analysts look at clinic attendance data to help hospitals and doctors offices predict when rush hours will hit so they can be ready for it. Your local city hospital is a great example. Let's say they've been getting complaints about long wait times. Sometimes an hour or more,

which made it hard for some patients to get the care they needed. So data analysts use data about the

hospitals daily foot traffic to help them make more informed decisions about how many doctors they need on staff at any given time. This helped reduce wait times, improve their patients' experience, and make better use of the health

care worker's time too. Like I said, there are many ways that

companies in different industries put data to use, but they can only do that if

they have data analysts they can rely on. So you might be wondering,

how you fit into the equation? Well, you've got plenty of options, but you don't have to decide what industry

you want to work in right away. There will be plenty of time to think about that

as you make your way through this program. By the time you finish this program, you

have the core skills that will make you valuable in any industry that

makes data-driven decisions. Which, as it turns out,

is most industries, even zoos. Coming up, we'll check out the business

task where data can be helpful. And, we'll explore even more how data

analysts are empowering businesses through data. I'll see you then.